Robert French

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Academic Positions

Loyola Marymount University
Assistant Professor, Department of Economics — 08/2025 –

University of Chicago
Postdoctoral Fellow, Harris School of Public Policy & Mansueto Institute — 08/2024 – 07/2025

Education

Harvard University
Ph.D. Public Policy — 2024

University of Toronto
M.A. Economics — 2016
B.A. Economics — 2014

Research Areas

Urban and Real Estate Economics, Public Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Working Papers

Quantifying the Welfare Impacts of Gentrification on Incumbent Renters (*with Ashvin Gandhi & Valentine Gilbert*)

Suburban Housing and Urban Affordability: Evidence from Residential Vacancy Chains (*with Valentine Gilbert*)

Publications

Behavioral barriers transitioning to college
Labour Economics, 2017, 47. (*with Philip Oreopoulos*)

Applying behavioural economics to public policy in Canada
Canadian Journal of Economics, 2017, 50. (*with Philip Oreopoulos*).

Selected Work in Progress

Schools or Suitcases? Optimal Urban Policy and Economic Opportunity in Greater Boston

Taxed Out or Cashing In? Property Taxes, Home Values, and Homeowner Decisions in Gentrifying Neighborhoods (*with Christopher Berry and Ashvin Gandhi*)

House Price Dynamics and Property Tax Inequity (*with Christopher Berry, Guangbin Hong, Eric Langowski*)

Other Research Experience

New York University
Visiting Researcher, Furman Center — 06/2022 - 07/2022

University of Toronto
Research Assistant to Philip Oreopoulos — 2016–2017
Research Assistant to Kory Kroft — 2014–2015

Fellowships, Research Awards & Grants

Junior Scholar, American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association	AY 2024–2025
Best Junior Paper Submitted for the 2024 AREUEA National Conference	2024
Best Paper on Housing by a Doctoral Student, Joint Center for Housing Studies	2024
Research Grant, Horowitz Foundation for Social Policy	2023
Adam Smith Fellowship (Declined), Mercatus Center	2023
Research Grant (×2), Malcolm Weiner Center for Social Policy	2022, 2023
Graduate Admission Scholarship, University of Toronto	AY 2015–2016
Louis Savlov Scholarship, University of Toronto	AY 2013–2014

Teaching Experience

Loyola Marymount University

Econometrics, Instructor	AY 2025-2026, Fall 2026
Computational Economics, Instructor	Spring 2026

Harvard University

PhD Micro Theory II (HKS), Head Teaching Fellow	Spring 2020, 2021, 2022, 2024
PhD Micro Theory I (HKS), Head Teaching Fellow	Fall 2021
Intermediate Micro Theory: Advanced, Head Teaching Fellow	Fall 2019, 2020

University of Toronto

Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant	AY 2015–2016
Economic Thought after 1870, Teaching Assistant	Spring 2016

Teaching Distinctions

Derek Bok Certification of Distinction in Teaching (×3), Harvard University — Spring 2021, AY 2021–2022

Invited Talks

Scheduled

2026: AREUEA-ASSA, Claremont McKenna, LMU Spring Macro Workshop

2025: Purdue University, Loyola Marymount University, Chicago Fed Urban Economics Workshop, UW-Madison Real Estate, University of North Texas, IIOC, WEA, USC Price, Junior Urban and Spatial Workshop, UEA North America, University of Utah School of Business

2024: UEA North America, UEA Europe, AREUEA-National, UCLA Ziman Center Conference on Low-Income Housing Supply and Housing Affordability, RUSH Online Seminar, Mansueto Institute for Urban Innovation, Loyola Marymount University (JM), University of Cincinnati Finance (JM), Texas A&M (JM)

2023 and earlier: NYU Furman Center, Harvard Kennedy School Economics and Social Policy

Professional Activities & Service

Referee:
Quarterly Journal of Economics (×7), Journal of Urban Economics (×2), Journal of Public Economics, National Tax Journal, Journal of Urban Affairs, Journal of Behavioral Public Administration

Discussant:
2025: AREUEA-ASSA (×3), IIOC, WEA, UEA NA
2024: AREUEA National, UEA Europe

Software

Julia, STATA, LaTeX

Personal

UK and Canadian Citizen
US Census Bureau Special Sworn Status